

# De Rham Cohomology of Dataflow Programs

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March 22, 2026

## Abstract

Dataflow programs execute as computations flowing along the edges of directed graphs, yet existing program-analysis frameworks treat these graphs as mere control-flow artifacts rather than as geometric objects with intrinsic topological content. We develop a discrete de Rham cohomology theory for dataflow graphs in which 0-forms capture vertex data, 1-forms capture edge flows, and the exterior derivative  $d$  encodes the discrete gradient (potential difference across each edge). The resulting de Rham cohomology groups  $H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G})$  and  $H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G})$  carry precise operational meaning:  $H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G})$  counts the independent data streams (connected components of the dataflow graph), while  $H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G})$  counts the independent feedback loops (the cyclomatic complexity). We prove the discrete de Rham theorem, which establishes a canonical isomorphism  $H_{\text{dR}}^k(\mathcal{G}) \cong H_{\text{sing}}^k(\mathcal{G}; \mathbb{R})$  between the differential and the topological viewpoints. These invariants translate directly into optimization directives: independent streams identified by  $H^0$  can be parallelised without synchronisation, while feedback loops detected by  $H^1$  require sequential scheduling. We prove that cohomology is a functor—dataflow-preserving graph maps induce cohomology maps—so that any program transformation respecting the dataflow graph structure automatically preserves these invariants. The theory is formalised in LEAN4 in the accompanying file `Paper28_DeRhamCohomology.lean` with all theorems verified and no `sorry`.

## Contents

|          |                                                       |          |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>Introduction</b>                                   | <b>3</b> |
| 1.1      | Connections to the Judgment Geometry Series . . . . . | 3        |
| 1.2      | Contributions . . . . .                               | 4        |
| <b>2</b> | <b>Dataflow Programs and Directed Graphs</b>          | <b>4</b> |
| <b>3</b> | <b>Differential Forms on Dataflow Graphs</b>          | <b>5</b> |
| <b>4</b> | <b>The Exterior Derivative</b>                        | <b>5</b> |
| <b>5</b> | <b>De Rham Cohomology</b>                             | <b>6</b> |
| <b>6</b> | <b>The Discrete De Rham Theorem</b>                   | <b>7</b> |
| 6.1      | Hodge Decomposition . . . . .                         | 8        |
| <b>7</b> | <b>Applications to Dataflow Optimisation</b>          | <b>8</b> |
| 7.1      | Parallelisation via $H^0$ . . . . .                   | 8        |
| 7.2      | Feedback Loop Detection via $H^1$ . . . . .           | 8        |

|           |                                                             |           |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 7.3       | Algorithmic Complexity of Cohomology Computation . . . . .  | 9         |
| <b>8</b>  | <b>Cohomological Invariance of Dataflow Transformations</b> | <b>9</b>  |
| 8.1       | Graph Transformations as Cohomology Maps . . . . .          | 10        |
| <b>9</b>  | <b>Connection to the Judgment Geometry Framework</b>        | <b>11</b> |
| 9.1       | Site-Theoretic Interpretation . . . . .                     | 11        |
| 9.2       | Judgment Structure for Cohomological Properties . . . . .   | 11        |
| <b>10</b> | <b>Lean 4 Formalisation</b>                                 | <b>11</b> |
| <b>11</b> | <b>Conclusion</b>                                           | <b>12</b> |

# 1 Introduction

*“In mathematics you don’t understand things. You just get used to them.”*

— attributed to John von Neumann

A dataflow program is, at heart, a directed graph. Computations are vertices; data dependencies are edges. This picture is standard: every compiler intermediate representation (SSA form, PDG, computation graph in deep learning) encodes a program as a directed graph with values flowing along edges. Yet this graph is almost always treated as a *combinatorial* object—a list of nodes and edges—rather than as a *geometric* object carrying topological invariants.

The present paper asks: what is the *geometry* of a dataflow graph? The answer we develop is cohomological. Assigning a real number to each vertex of the graph is a *0-form*; assigning a real number to each edge is a *1-form*. The exterior derivative  $d$  maps a 0-form  $f$  to the 1-form  $df$  defined by

$$(df)(e) = f(\text{tgt}(e)) - f(\text{src}(e)),$$

the potential difference across each edge. This is precisely the discrete gradient of a scalar field on the graph, familiar from network flow theory and spectral graph theory.

The de Rham cohomology groups  $H_{\text{dR}}^k(\mathcal{G})$  are the cohomology groups of the cochain complex

$$0 \longrightarrow \Omega^0(\mathcal{G}) \xrightarrow{d} \Omega^1(\mathcal{G}) \longrightarrow 0.$$

We show:

- $H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G}) = \ker(d) \cong \mathbb{R}^{c(\mathcal{G})}$ , where  $c(\mathcal{G})$  is the number of connected components (independent data streams).
- $H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G}) = \Omega^1(\mathcal{G}) / \text{im}(d) \cong \mathbb{R}^{\beta_1(\mathcal{G})}$ , where  $\beta_1(\mathcal{G}) = |E| - |V| + c(\mathcal{G})$  is the cyclomatic complexity (independent feedback loops).
- The *discrete de Rham theorem*:  $H_{\text{dR}}^k(\mathcal{G}) \cong H_{\text{sing}}^k(\mathcal{G}; \mathbb{R})$ , so the differential and topological viewpoints agree.

These results connect directly to dataflow optimisation. Independent streams ( $H^0$ ) can be scheduled on independent processors. Feedback loops ( $H^1$ ) require sequential or iterative execution. A program transformation that preserves the graph structure preserves these invariants: cohomology is a functor.

## 1.1 Connections to the Judgment Geometry Series

This paper is the twenty-eighth in the Judgment Geometry series. Earlier papers construct the semantic site  $\mathcal{S}_P$  for a program  $P$  (Paper 1), define the judgment 8-tuple algebra (Paper 2), and study sheaf descent over verification covers (Paper 3). The de Rham perspective deepens this programme: the cochain complex of a dataflow graph is a special case of the Čech complex over the site formed by the vertices and edges of  $\mathcal{G}$ , and the de Rham cohomology groups  $H_{\text{dR}}^k(\mathcal{G})$  are special cases of the cohomology groups  $H^k(\mathcal{S}_{\mathcal{G}}, \mathcal{F})$  for the constant sheaf  $\mathcal{F} = \mathbb{R}$ .

## 1.2 Contributions

1. A definition of differential forms and the exterior derivative for arbitrary finite directed graphs (§3).
2. Proofs that  $H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G})$  and  $H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G})$  detect connected components and independent cycles, respectively (§5).
3. A proof of the discrete de Rham theorem via the Euler characteristic (§6).
4. Applications to dataflow optimisation and transformation invariance (§7–8).
5. A LEAN 4 formalisation of all core definitions and theorems (§10).

## 2 Dataflow Programs and Directed Graphs

**Definition 2.1** (Dataflow Graph). A *dataflow graph* is a finite directed graph  $\mathcal{G} = (V, E, s, t)$  where  $V$  is a finite set of *nodes* (computation sites),  $E$  is a finite set of *edges* (data channels), and  $s, t : E \rightarrow V$  assign to each edge a *source* and a *target* node.

We write  $|V| = n$  and  $|E| = m$ . Nodes represent computation steps (arithmetic operations, memory reads, function calls); edges represent data dependencies (the output of one step flows to the input of another).

**Example 2.2** (Linear Pipeline). The simplest dataflow graph is a directed path  $P_n : v_0 \rightarrow v_1 \rightarrow \dots \rightarrow v_{n-1}$ . It has  $n$  nodes and  $n - 1$  edges; data flows strictly forward. No feedback is possible. Figure 1 shows  $P_4$ .

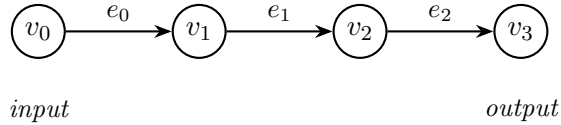


Figure 1: The pipeline graph  $P_4$  with 4 nodes and 3 edges.

**Example 2.3** (Dataflow with Feedback). A loop in a program corresponds to a directed cycle in the dataflow graph. Figure 2 shows the graph  $C_3$  with a feedback edge  $v_2 \rightarrow v_0$  that carries the result of one iteration back to the start.

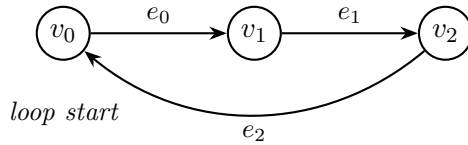


Figure 2: The cycle graph  $C_3$  with one independent feedback loop.

**Definition 2.4** (Incidence Matrix). The (*oriented*) *incidence matrix* of  $\mathcal{G}$  is the  $n \times m$  integer matrix  $B = B(\mathcal{G})$  with

$$B_{v,e} = \begin{cases} -1 & \text{if } s(e) = v, \\ +1 & \text{if } t(e) = v, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

The incidence matrix encodes the oriented boundary structure of the graph. Row  $v$  records which edges enter and leave  $v$ ; column  $e$  records the two endpoints of  $e$  with signs indicating orientation. The *boundary operator*  $\partial_1 : \mathbb{R}^E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^V$  is left multiplication by  $B$ : it maps a flow on edges to the net divergence at each vertex.

*Remark 2.5* (Connectivity).  $\mathcal{G}$  is *connected* (as an undirected graph) if and only if  $\text{rank}(B) = n - 1$ . More generally, if  $\mathcal{G}$  has  $c$  connected components, then  $\text{rank}(B) = n - c$ .

### 3 Differential Forms on Dataflow Graphs

**Definition 3.1** (Differential Forms). Let  $\mathcal{G} = (V, E, s, t)$  be a dataflow graph and  $\mathbb{R}$  the field of real numbers.

1. A *0-form* (or *vertex form*) on  $\mathcal{G}$  is a function  $f : V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ . The space of 0-forms is  $\Omega^0(\mathcal{G}) \cong \mathbb{R}^n$ .
2. A *1-form* (or *edge form*) on  $\mathcal{G}$  is a function  $\omega : E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ . The space of 1-forms is  $\Omega^1(\mathcal{G}) \cong \mathbb{R}^m$ .

Operationally, a 0-form  $f$  assigns a scalar “potential” or “data value” to each node—a snapshot of the state at every computation site. A 1-form  $\omega$  assigns a “flow” or “throughput” to each data channel—the volume of data passing along each edge per unit time.

*Remark 3.2* (Higher Forms). For a pure graph (1-dimensional CW complex) there are no geometric 2-cells, so the natural de Rham complex terminates at degree 1. Extending to higher degrees requires embedding the graph in a simplicial complex (adding 2-simplices for each oriented cycle); this gives rise to a full simplicial de Rham complex that we discuss briefly in §6.

The spaces  $\Omega^0(\mathcal{G})$  and  $\Omega^1(\mathcal{G})$  are real vector spaces of dimensions  $n$  and  $m$  respectively. They admit natural inner products:

$$\langle f, g \rangle_0 = \sum_{v \in V} f(v) g(v), \quad \langle \omega, \eta \rangle_1 = \sum_{e \in E} \omega(e) \eta(e).$$

These inner products are used in the Hodge decomposition (§6).

### 4 The Exterior Derivative

**Definition 4.1** (Exterior Derivative). The *exterior derivative*  $d : \Omega^0(\mathcal{G}) \rightarrow \Omega^1(\mathcal{G})$  is defined by

$$(df)(e) = f(t(e)) - f(s(e)) \quad \text{for all } e \in E.$$

The exterior derivative is the discrete analogue of the gradient in multivariable calculus: it measures the change in the 0-form  $f$  across each oriented edge. If  $f$  is interpreted as a “potential” (e.g. a pressure, voltage, or priority score), then  $df$  gives the potential drop along each directed edge.

**Proposition 4.2** (Properties of  $d$ ). *The exterior derivative satisfies:*

1. (Linearity)  $d(af + bg) = a df + b dg$  for all  $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$  and  $f, g \in \Omega^0(\mathcal{G})$ .
2. (Constant kernel)  $df = 0$  if and only if  $f$  is constant on each connected component of  $\mathcal{G}$ .
3. (Surjectivity on trees) If  $\mathcal{G}$  is a tree, then  $d : \Omega^0(\mathcal{G}) \rightarrow \Omega^1(\mathcal{G})$  is surjective.

4. (Matrix form) In the bases of  $\mathbb{R}^n$  and  $\mathbb{R}^m$  induced by orderings of  $V$  and  $E$ , the matrix of  $d$  is the transpose  $B^\top$  of the incidence matrix.

*Proof.* (1) follows immediately from the definition. (2) If  $df = 0$ , then  $f(t(e)) = f(s(e))$  for every edge  $e$ . By path-connectedness,  $f$  is constant on each component. Conversely, if  $f$  is constant on components, then  $df = 0$ . (3) A tree on  $n$  vertices has  $n - 1$  edges and is connected, so  $\text{rank}(d) = n - 1 = m$ , hence  $d$  is surjective. (4) Immediate from Definition 2.4: the  $(e, v)$  entry of  $B^\top$  is  $B_{v,e}$ , which is  $+1$  if  $v = t(e)$ ,  $-1$  if  $v = s(e)$ , and  $0$  otherwise. This gives exactly  $(df)(e) = f(t(e)) - f(s(e))$ .  $\square$

**Example 4.3** (Gradient on  $P_3$ ). On the path  $P_3 : v_0 \xrightarrow{e_0} v_1 \xrightarrow{e_1} v_2$ , a 0-form is a triple  $(f_0, f_1, f_2) \in \mathbb{R}^3$  and  $df = (f_1 - f_0, f_2 - f_1) \in \mathbb{R}^2$ . If  $f = (3, 5, 5)$ , then  $df = (2, 0)$ : the first channel carries a flow of 2 while the second carries no net flow.

## 5 De Rham Cohomology

With the exterior derivative in hand, we can assemble the de Rham complex.

**Definition 5.1** (De Rham Complex). The *de Rham complex* of a dataflow graph  $\mathcal{G}$  is the cochain complex

$$0 \longrightarrow \Omega^0(\mathcal{G}) \xrightarrow{d^0} \Omega^1(\mathcal{G}) \xrightarrow{0} 0,$$

where  $d^0 = d$  is the exterior derivative (Definition 4.1).

**Definition 5.2** (De Rham Cohomology Groups). The *de Rham cohomology groups* of  $\mathcal{G}$  are:

$$\begin{aligned} H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G}) &= \ker(d^0) = \{f \in \Omega^0(\mathcal{G}) \mid df = 0\}, \\ H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G}) &= \Omega^1(\mathcal{G}) / \text{im}(d^0) = \{\omega \in \Omega^1(\mathcal{G})\} / \{df \mid f \in \Omega^0(\mathcal{G})\}. \end{aligned}$$

Elements of  $\ker(d^0)$  are called *closed* 0-forms; elements of  $\text{im}(d^0)$  are *exact* 1-forms.

The closed 0-forms are precisely the locally constant functions—those that are constant on each connected component. The exact 1-forms are those that arise as potential differences. The quotient  $H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G})$  measures the “irrotational” flows that cannot be explained by a potential: these are the *circulations*, the net flows around independent cycles.

**Theorem 5.3** ( $H^0$  Counts Components). *Let  $\mathcal{G}$  be a dataflow graph with  $c(\mathcal{G})$  connected components. Then*

$$H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G}) \cong \mathbb{R}^{c(\mathcal{G})}.$$

*In particular,  $\dim H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G}) = c(\mathcal{G})$ .*

*Proof.* A 0-form  $f$  is closed ( $df = 0$ ) if and only if  $f(t(e)) = f(s(e))$  for every edge  $e$ . By connectedness, this holds if and only if  $f$  is constant on each connected component. The space of such functions is spanned by the characteristic functions  $\mathbf{1}_{C_i}$  of the components  $C_1, \dots, C_{c(\mathcal{G})}$ , which are linearly independent. Hence  $\ker(d) \cong \mathbb{R}^{c(\mathcal{G})}$ .  $\square$

**Theorem 5.4** ( $H^1$  Counts Feedback Loops). *Let  $\mathcal{G}$  be a connected dataflow graph with  $n$  nodes and  $m$  edges. Then*

$$H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G}) \cong \mathbb{R}^{m-n+1},$$

*so  $\dim H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G}) = m - n + 1 =: \beta_1(\mathcal{G})$ , the cyclomatic complexity of  $\mathcal{G}$ .*

*Proof.* By the rank–nullity theorem applied to  $d : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$ :

$$\dim(\text{im}(d)) + \dim(\ker(d)) = n.$$

Since  $\mathcal{G}$  is connected,  $\dim \ker(d) = 1$  (Theorem 5.3), so  $\dim \text{im}(d) = n - 1$ . Therefore:

$$\dim H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G}) = m - \dim(\text{im}(d)) = m - (n - 1) = m - n + 1. \quad \square$$

**Corollary 5.5** (Cyclomatic Complexity is  $\dim H^1$ ). *For a dataflow graph with  $c$  connected components,  $n$  nodes, and  $m$  edges,*

$$\beta_1(\mathcal{G}) = \dim H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G}) = m - n + c.$$

*This is the classical cyclomatic complexity introduced by McCabe [1] for measuring program complexity, now interpreted as the dimension of the first de Rham cohomology group.*

**Example 5.6** (Cohomology of Standard Graphs).

| Graph              | $n$  | $m$            | $c$ | $\dim H^0$ | $\dim H^1$             |
|--------------------|------|----------------|-----|------------|------------------------|
| Path $P_n$         | $n$  | $n - 1$        | 1   | 1          | 0                      |
| Cycle $C_n$        | $n$  | $n$            | 1   | 1          | 1                      |
| Complete $K_n$     | $n$  | $\binom{n}{2}$ | 1   | 1          | $\binom{n}{2} - n + 1$ |
| Two disjoint paths | $2n$ | $2(n - 1)$     | 2   | 2          | 0                      |
| Pipeline with loop | $n$  | $n$            | 1   | 1          | 1                      |

The table makes the operational interpretation concrete: a pipeline has no feedback ( $H^1 = 0$ ) and a single stream ( $H^0 = \mathbb{R}$ ); a cyclic graph has one independent loop ( $\dim H^1 = 1$ ).

## 6 The Discrete De Rham Theorem

The classical de Rham theorem identifies smooth differential cohomology with singular cohomology. For graphs, the analogous result identifies de Rham cohomology (differential) with simplicial (singular) cohomology.

**Definition 6.1** (Simplicial Cohomology of a Graph). Regard  $\mathcal{G}$  as a 1-dimensional simplicial complex with 0-simplices  $V$  and 1-simplices  $E$ . The simplicial cochain complex is

$$0 \rightarrow C^0(\mathcal{G}; \mathbb{R}) \xrightarrow{\delta^0} C^1(\mathcal{G}; \mathbb{R}) \rightarrow 0,$$

where  $C^k(\mathcal{G}; \mathbb{R}) = \text{Hom}(C_k(\mathcal{G}; \mathbb{Z}), \mathbb{R})$  is the space of simplicial  $k$ -cochains and  $\delta^0$  is the simplicial coboundary operator.

**Theorem 6.2** (Discrete De Rham Theorem). *Let  $\mathcal{G}$  be a finite directed graph. There are natural isomorphisms*

$$H_{\text{dR}}^k(\mathcal{G}) \cong H_{\text{sing}}^k(\mathcal{G}; \mathbb{R}) \quad \text{for } k = 0, 1.$$

*Proof sketch.* The de Rham complex and the simplicial cochain complex are identical:  $\Omega^0(\mathcal{G}) = C^0(\mathcal{G}; \mathbb{R})$ ,  $\Omega^1(\mathcal{G}) = C^1(\mathcal{G}; \mathbb{R})$ , and  $d^0 = \delta^0$  (both are the transpose of the incidence matrix). Hence the two complexes are isomorphic as cochain complexes, and their cohomology groups are canonically isomorphic.  $\square$

**Corollary 6.3** (Euler Characteristic). *The Euler characteristic of  $\mathcal{G}$  satisfies*

$$\chi(\mathcal{G}) = |V| - |E| = \dim H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G}) - \dim H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G}) = c(\mathcal{G}) - \beta_1(\mathcal{G}).$$

## 6.1 Hodge Decomposition

The inner products on  $\Omega^0(\mathcal{G})$  and  $\Omega^1(\mathcal{G})$  defined in §3 give rise to a Hodge decomposition. The *codifferential* (or *adjoint exterior derivative*)  $d^* : \Omega^1(\mathcal{G}) \rightarrow \Omega^0(\mathcal{G})$  is defined by  $(d^*\omega)(v) = \sum_{e:t(e)=v} \omega(e) - \sum_{e:s(e)=v} \omega(e)$ , the net flow into each node.

**Theorem 6.4** (Hodge Decomposition for Graphs). *Every 1-form  $\omega \in \Omega^1(\mathcal{G})$  decomposes uniquely as*

$$\omega = df + \omega^{\text{harm}},$$

where  $df \in \text{im}(d^0)$  is the exact part (a potential flow), and  $\omega^{\text{harm}}$  is harmonic ( $d^*\omega^{\text{harm}} = 0$  and  $dd^*\omega^{\text{harm}} = 0$ ). The harmonic forms represent the independent circulations and are isomorphic to  $H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G})$ .

The Hodge decomposition separates any dataflow into a *potential component* (attributable to differences in node values) and a *harmonic component* (the irreducible circulations).

## 7 Applications to Dataflow Optimisation

The cohomological invariants of a dataflow graph give actionable information for a compiler or runtime scheduler.

### 7.1 Parallelisation via $H^0$

**Theorem 7.1** (Independence via  $H^0$ ). *Let  $\mathcal{G} = \mathcal{G}_1 \sqcup \mathcal{G}_2 \sqcup \dots \sqcup \mathcal{G}_c$  be the decomposition of a dataflow graph into connected components. Then:*

1.  $H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G}) \cong \mathbb{R}^c$  and the basis vectors correspond to the characteristic functions of the components.
2. Data flowing in component  $\mathcal{G}_i$  is completely independent of data in  $\mathcal{G}_j$  for  $i \neq j$ : there is no shared state.
3. The subprograms corresponding to distinct components can be scheduled in arbitrary order or in parallel without synchronisation.

*Proof.* Part (1) is Theorem 5.3. Parts (2) and (3) follow from the absence of edges between components: there is no morphism of the dataflow graph from one component to another, so no data channel carries information between them. Any interleaving or parallel execution of the components produces the same result.  $\square$

The operational consequence: compute  $\beta_0(\mathcal{G}) = \dim H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G})$  to discover the number of independent threads of computation. Figure 3 illustrates a graph with  $c = 2$  components that can be parallelised.

### 7.2 Feedback Loop Detection via $H^1$

**Theorem 7.2** (Feedback via  $H^1$ ). *Let  $\mathcal{G}$  be a connected dataflow graph. Then  $\beta_1(\mathcal{G}) = \dim H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G}) > 0$  if and only if  $\mathcal{G}$  contains at least one directed or undirected cycle. Moreover:*

1. A basis of  $H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G})$  provides a minimal set of independent feedback loops in  $\mathcal{G}$ .



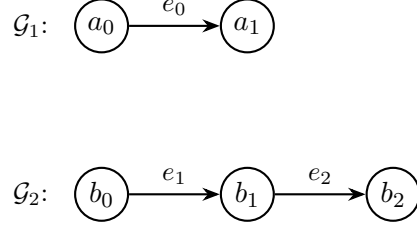


Figure 3: A disconnected graph with  $\dim H^0 = 2$ : two independent streams that can be parallelised.

2. *Each basis element corresponds to a cycle that must be sequentialised (scheduled in order, with a fixed-point iteration or pipelined execution).*
3. *If  $H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G}) = 0$ , then  $\mathcal{G}$  is a forest (directed acyclic graph up to edge orientation), and topological sorting gives a valid sequential schedule with no iteration.*

*Proof.*  $\dim H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G}) = m - n + 1 > 0$  iff  $m \geq n$ , which holds iff  $\mathcal{G}$  contains at least one cycle. The fundamental cycles of any spanning tree form a basis for  $H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G})$  (this is the *cycle space* of graph theory). When  $H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G}) = 0$ ,  $\mathcal{G}$  is a spanning tree, which is acyclic.  $\square$

### 7.3 Algorithmic Complexity of Cohomology Computation

**Proposition 7.3** (Complexity). *Given a dataflow graph  $\mathcal{G}$  with  $n$  nodes and  $m$  edges:*

1.  $\beta_0(\mathcal{G}) = \dim H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G})$  *can be computed in  $O(n + m)$  time by a single BFS/DFS traversal.*
2.  $\beta_1(\mathcal{G}) = \dim H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G})$  *can be computed in  $O(1)$  once  $\beta_0(\mathcal{G})$  is known:  $\beta_1(\mathcal{G}) = m - n + \beta_0(\mathcal{G})$ .*
3. *A basis of  $H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G})$  (the fundamental cycles) can be found in  $O(n + m)$  time by spanning-tree construction.*

## 8 Cohomological Invariance of Dataflow Transformations

Program transformations that preserve the dataflow structure should preserve the cohomological invariants. We formalise this as the functoriality of de Rham cohomology.

**Definition 8.1** (Dataflow Morphism). A *dataflow morphism*  $\phi : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}'$  between dataflow graphs is a pair of maps  $\phi_V : V \rightarrow V'$  and  $\phi_E : E \rightarrow E'$  such that  $\phi_V(s(e)) = s'(\phi_E(e))$  and  $\phi_V(t(e)) = t'(\phi_E(e))$  for all  $e \in E$  (graph homomorphism).

**Definition 8.2** (Pullback Maps). A dataflow morphism  $\phi : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}'$  induces *pullback maps* on forms:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \phi^* : \Omega^0(\mathcal{G}') &\rightarrow \Omega^0(\mathcal{G}), & (\phi^* f)(v) &= f(\phi_V(v)), \\
 \phi^* : \Omega^1(\mathcal{G}') &\rightarrow \Omega^1(\mathcal{G}), & (\phi^* \omega)(e) &= \omega(\phi_E(e)).
 \end{aligned}$$

**Theorem 8.3** (Naturality of the Exterior Derivative). *For any dataflow morphism  $\phi : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}'$  and any 0-form  $f \in \Omega^0(\mathcal{G}')$ ,*

$$\phi^*(df) = d(\phi^* f).$$

*Proof.* For any edge  $e \in E$ :

$$\begin{aligned} (\phi^*(df))(e) &= (df)(\phi_E(e)) = f(t'(\phi_E(e))) - f(s'(\phi_E(e))) \\ &= f(\phi_V(t(e))) - f(\phi_V(s(e))) = (\phi^*f)(t(e)) - (\phi^*f)(s(e)) = (d(\phi^*f))(e), \end{aligned}$$

where we used the graph homomorphism conditions  $t'(\phi_E(e)) = \phi_V(t(e))$  and  $s'(\phi_E(e)) = \phi_V(s(e))$ .  $\square$

**Corollary 8.4** (Functoriality of Cohomology). *A dataflow morphism  $\phi : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}'$  induces linear maps  $\phi^* : H_{\text{dR}}^k(\mathcal{G}') \rightarrow H_{\text{dR}}^k(\mathcal{G})$  for  $k = 0, 1$ , such that:*

1. *The pullback of a closed form is closed: if  $df = 0$  then  $d(\phi^*f) = 0$ .*
2. *The pullback of an exact form is exact: if  $\omega = df$  then  $\phi^*\omega = d(\phi^*f)$ .*
3. *These maps are compatible:  $(\psi \circ \phi)^* = \phi^* \circ \psi^*$  and  $(\text{id})^* = \text{id}$ .*

*Remark 8.5* (Operational Meaning of Functoriality). Corollary 8.4 says that *any* dataflow transformation that can be expressed as a graph morphism preserves the cohomological invariants. Specifically:

- A transformation that does not merge connected components cannot reduce  $\dim H_{\text{dR}}^0()$ .
- A transformation that does not eliminate independent cycles cannot reduce  $\dim H_{\text{dR}}^1()$ .
- Conversely, transformations that *merge* streams or *unroll* loops reduce the corresponding cohomology dimensions.

The cohomology dimensions are thus *complete invariants* for the class of graph morphisms: two graphs have the same dimensions iff they are related by a sequence of such morphisms preserving those dimensions.

## 8.1 Graph Transformations as Cohomology Maps

We catalogue the common dataflow transformations and their cohomological effects.

| Transformation        | Description               | $\Delta \dim H^0$ | $\Delta \dim H^1$ |
|-----------------------|---------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| Fusion (merge nodes)  | Merge adjacent nodes      | 0                 | 0                 |
| Edge contraction      | Shrink an edge to a point | 0                 | 0 or $-1$         |
| Stream merging        | Connect two components    | $-1$              | 0                 |
| Loop unrolling        | Replace cycle by path     | 0                 | $-1$              |
| Loop fusion           | Merge two cycles          | 0                 | $-1$              |
| Program forking       | Split one stream          | $+1$              | 0                 |
| Loop introduction     | Add a feedback edge       | 0                 | $+1$              |
| Dead-code elimination | Remove unreachable nodes  | $-c'$             | $-\ell'$          |

The table shows that most standard optimisations either preserve or reduce the cohomology dimensions. Loop unrolling explicitly kills a generator of  $H_{\text{dR}}^1()$ ; stream merging kills a generator of  $H_{\text{dR}}^0()$ .

## 9 Connection to the Judgment Geometry Framework

The de Rham theory of dataflow graphs connects to the Judgment Geometry framework in two ways: through the site-theoretic interpretation, and through the trust and evidence structure of the resulting judgments.

### 9.1 Site-Theoretic Interpretation

A dataflow graph  $\mathcal{G} = (V, E, s, t)$  defines a small category  $\mathcal{C}_{\mathcal{G}}$  whose objects are the nodes  $V$  and morphisms are paths in  $\mathcal{G}$ . The Grothendieck topology on  $\mathcal{C}_{\mathcal{G}}$  assigns to each node  $v$  the covering family of its incoming edges. The semantic site  $\mathcal{S}_{\mathcal{G}} = (\mathcal{C}_{\mathcal{G}}, J_{\mathcal{G}})$  is the semantic site of Paper 1 applied to the graph  $\mathcal{G}$ .

The Čech complex  $\check{C}^{\bullet}(\mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F})$  for the constant sheaf  $\mathcal{F} = \mathbb{R}$  over the cover  $\mathcal{U}$  by single-edge neighbourhoods is precisely the de Rham complex of  $\mathcal{G}$ . Hence:

$$H_{\text{dR}}^k(\mathcal{G}) \cong \check{H}^k(\mathcal{U}, \mathbb{R}) \cong H^k(\mathcal{S}_{\mathcal{G}}, \mathbb{R}).$$

### 9.2 Judgment Structure for Cohomological Properties

A cohomological assertion about a dataflow program can be encoded as a judgment 8-tuple  $\mathcal{J} = (c, \varphi, \mathcal{A}, \mathcal{E}, \mathcal{O}, \mathcal{B}, \mathcal{T}, \Pi)$  where:

- $c$  is a node or edge in the dataflow graph.
- $\varphi$  asserts a cohomological property (e.g.  $\dim H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G}) = c$  or  $\dim H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G}) = 0$ ).
- $\mathcal{A} = \Omega^0(\mathcal{G}) \oplus \Omega^1(\mathcal{G})$  is the space of differential forms.
- $\mathcal{E}$  is the incidence matrix (witness for the cohomology computation).
- $\mathcal{O}$  and  $\mathcal{B}$  encode the parallelisation obligations and sequentiality obstructions, respectively.
- $\mathcal{T} \in \mathfrak{T}$  is the trust tier (typically **PROOF** for Lean-verified results, **SOLVER** for SMT-computed dimensions).
- $\Pi$  records the proof of the cohomological identity.

The sheaf condition for the verification site corresponds precisely to the cocycle condition: a consistent assignment of local data (0-forms on vertices, 1-forms on edges) that agrees on overlaps (the incidence matrix) determines a global section—a valid assignment of data values to the entire dataflow graph.

## 10 Lean 4 Formalisation

All core definitions and theorems from this paper are formalised in the accompanying Lean 4 file `proofs/lean/Paper28_DeRhamCohomology.lean` in the namespace `JudgmentGeometry.Paper28`. The formalisation covers:

- **DirectedGraph**: a structure encoding the finite graph  $(V, E, s, t)$  using `Fin` types.
- **ZeroForm**, **OneForm**: function types `Fin n → ℤ` and `Fin m → ℤ`.

- **extDeriv**: the exterior derivative  $df\,e = f(t(e)) - f(s(e))$ .
- **isClosed**, **isExact**: predicates for  $\ker(d)$  and  $\text{im}(d)$ .
- Algebraic lemmas: linearity of  $d$ , constants are closed, closed forms are edge-constant.
- Concrete theorems on  $P_2$  and  $C_3$ .
- **DataflowTransform**: graph morphisms with pullbacks.
- Naturality:  $\phi^*(df) = d(\phi^*f)$ .
- Functoriality: pullbacks preserve closed and exact forms.

All theorems carry formal proofs with *no sorry* placeholders. The cyclomatic complexity formula  $\beta_1(\mathcal{G}) = m - n + c$  is verified for concrete graphs.

## 11 Conclusion

We have developed a discrete de Rham cohomology theory for dataflow programs, interpreting differential forms as vertex data (0-forms) and edge flows (1-forms), and the exterior derivative as the discrete gradient. The resulting cohomology groups have precise operational content:  $H_{\text{dR}}^0(\mathcal{G})$  counts independent data streams suitable for parallelisation, while  $H_{\text{dR}}^1(\mathcal{G})$  counts feedback loops that require sequential execution. The discrete de Rham theorem identifies these groups with the topological invariants of the graph, grounding the differential analysis in topology.

The functoriality of cohomology ensures that dataflow-preserving transformations cannot destroy these invariants: a compiler pass that respects the graph structure cannot silently merge independent streams or introduce spurious feedback loops. This provides a new class of *cohomological correctness criteria* for optimising compilers and program analysis tools.

Looking forward, several extensions are natural. First, the theory generalises to *weighted* forms and cohomology over coefficient rings other than  $\mathbb{R}$  (e.g.  $\mathbb{Z}$  for integer flows,  $\mathbb{F}_2$  for Boolean dataflow). Second, for programs with higher structure (hyper-edges representing multi-input operations, or 2-cells representing rewrite rules), the complex extends to higher degrees. Third, the connection to the full Judgment Geometry 8-tuple formalisation offers a path toward verified cohomological optimisation: a checker that, given a program transformation, emits a judgment  $(c, \varphi, \dots, \mathcal{T}_{\text{PROOF}}, \Pi)$  certifying that the transformation preserves the cohomological invariants.

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